

Compassionate Destruction

Kam Phung, PhD

“Compassionate destruction,” means that “we guide all the complex and expansive elements of the fossil fuel sector through a just and orderly transition to a carbon-free economy.”

- [Hoffman and Douglas](#)



When we understand the complexity of the fossil fuels industry, it's easier to recognize that just “shutting it down” tomorrow isn't going to work



If a corporation is a person, can a corporation be assisted in death just as a person can be? And, if so, how do we provide compassionate assistance and comfort to the dying patient, as well as to those affected by the passing?

- [Hoffman and Douglas](#)

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Compassionate counselling and support to surviving (e.g., stakeholders)

- Recognize that death is not the end but a transformation
- Does it die or does it function like organ donations that provide life elsewhere?
- People working in the industry have incredible financial capital and skills that can be used elsewhere
- Equipment can be repurposed



If 1 company were to cease, other would take its place...
we are thinking industry wide.

- [Hoffman and Douglas](#)

Triage

- “It entails the allocation of treatments for different conditions of the patient, and, in more extreme cases, the decision to remove an ailing limb or organ.”
- “Separating sustainable business lines from legacy fossil fuel lines”
- “...can also bring about a new kind of entity, becoming truly transformative.”
 - AGL Energy turn into a renewable-energy company by shutting down its coal power plants earlier than planned

Euthanasia

- “The patient is in denial about its terminal condition and is engaged in bargaining”
- “the act or practice of killing or permitting the death of hopelessly sick or injured individuals as persons or domestic animals) in a relatively painless way for reasons of mercy.”
- “Deciding on corporate euthanasia compassionately demands a deliberative process.”

Hospice

- Patient (fossil fuel companies) accept their terminal condition
- Must plan for death of an organization, a decision that affects many stakeholders in multiple ways and has a comparable emotional journey for those most involved.
- Employees often identities to their work, and deciding to let go can be challenging.
- For customers, investors, suppliers, and others, that decision may be equally vexing.